

SUBMISSION-QUALITY KNOWLEDGE HUB

Form FDA 356h: Facility-Readiness Prevention Guide

A manufacturer-side guide to getting establishment information right the first time

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Independent educational resource — please read

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The problem this guide solves

Form FDA 356h is both an administrative summary and the master record of every manufacturing, packaging, and control site behind an application — for drug substance and drug product alike. FDA has publicly noted that inaccurate or inconsistent 356h information creates extra work for both the Agency and the applicant and delays review. Complete, accurate establishment information reduces the frequency of Information Requests, Refuse-to-File, and Refuse-to-Receive actions and improves assessment efficiency.

This guide focuses on what the applicant / manufacturer controls: clean facility data and demonstrable inspection readiness.

Field 28 — establishment information done right

Every facility associated with the application must be identified completely and consistently. For each site, provide:

Data element	What “good” looks like
Establishment name	Legal name exactly as registered; no abbreviations that differ from registration.
Full address	Physical site address that matches FDA registration and the DMF, not a corporate HQ.
FEI number	Correct Facility Establishment Identifier for that physical site.
DUNS number	Site-level DUNS that resolves to the same physical address.
DMF number	Provided for drug substance / component sites referenced via a Drug Master File.
Function / role	Each role (API manufacture, drug product manufacture, packaging, testing, control) explicitly stated.

Data element	What “good” looks like
Top recurring 356h discrepancies to self-check Facilities listed on the form that do not appear in Module 3 — or vice versa. FEI / DUNS that do not resolve to the stated physical address. Missing DMF number or an unauthorized / expired Letter of Authorization for a referenced API site. Testing or packaging sites omitted because they were treated as “minor.” Role of a facility described differently on the form than in the body of the application.	

Inspection readiness — every site, including DMF holders

Listing a facility is not the same as the facility being ready. Each manufacturing and testing site — including Type II DMF holders — must be inspection-ready at the time of submission. If one or more facilities are not ready, FDA generally assigns a longer goal date and may defer substantive assessment, which erases any speed advantage you were seeking.

Readiness self-assessment, per site

- ☐ Site is registered, and registration is current for the relevant fiscal year.
- ☐ Quality system, batch records, and validation documentation for this product are in place and retrievable.
- ☐ Recent inspection history reviewed; any open observations have a documented status.
- ☐ DMF holder has confirmed readiness and an authorized, current Letter of Authorization is on file.
- ☐ A named site contact is identified and reachable for inspection scheduling.

Pre-Submission Facility Correspondence (PFC) — timing for prioritized ANDAs

For prioritized generic-drug applications, a Pre-Submission Facility Correspondence lets FDA confirm facility readiness ahead of the ANDA. The timing window is narrow and getting it wrong defeats the purpose:

Element	Guidance
When to file the PFC	As a stand-alone eCTD sequence no later than 60 days before the ANDA, and no earlier than 90 days, to avoid mid-stream facility changes.
Form 356h coding	Select “Product Correspondence” and “Other” in the Submission field, and “Pre-submission” in the Submission Sub-Type field.
Cover letter must state	Justification for expedited review, a statement of inspection readiness, identification of the RLD, and the anticipated ANDA submission date.
Scope	Confirm readiness for every manufacturing and testing facility, including Type II DMF holders.

Why readiness drives your goal date

Element	Guidance
	When all facilities are confirmed ready through the PFC, FDA can assign an earlier goal date. When one or more are not ready, FDA generally assigns a 15-month goal date and may defer substantive assessment of the original ANDA. Facility readiness is therefore a scheduling lever, not just a compliance box.

A practical prevention workflow

1. Build a single “facility master” table (name, address, FEI, DUNS, DMF, role, readiness status) and make it the single source of truth.
2. Populate Form 356h and Module 3 from that one table — never enter facility data twice by hand.
3. Obtain or refresh each DMF Letter of Authorization before drafting the form.
4. Run a readiness self-assessment per site and record the date completed.
5. Have a second reviewer reconcile the form against Module 3 and the cover letter.
6. For prioritized ANDAs, schedule the PFC inside the 60–90 day window.

Sources & further reading

This guide draws on the following publicly available FDA materials and regulations. Always confirm you are using the current version.

- Common Discrepancies Observed on the Form 356h with the ANDA Submission (FDA, GDF 2025) — <https://www.fda.gov/media/187312/download>
- ANDAs: Pre-Submission Facility Correspondence Related to Prioritized Generic Drug Submissions (Guidance for Industry) — [https://www.fda.gov/files/drugs/published/ANDAs--Pre-Submission-of-Facility-Information-Related-to-Prioritized-Generic-Drug-Applications-\(Pre-Submission-Facility-Correspondence\)-Guidance-for-Industry.pdf](https://www.fda.gov/files/drugs/published/ANDAs--Pre-Submission-of-Facility-Information-Related-to-Prioritized-Generic-Drug-Applications-(Pre-Submission-Facility-Correspondence)-Guidance-for-Industry.pdf)
- Facility Readiness: Goal Date Decisions Under GDUFA (Guidance for Industry) — <https://www.fda.gov/media/162018/download>
- Form FDA 356h (current edition) — <https://www.fda.gov/media/72649/download>
- ANDA Forms and Submission Requirements (FDA) — <https://www.fda.gov/drugs/abbreviated-new-drug-application-anda/abbreviated-new-drug-application-anda-forms-and-submission-requirements>